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The Book that Saved the Earth

-Claire Boiko

I Answer the following word meanings:-

1 Easel: A stand used to hold a painting
sentences The artist placed his canvas on the easel.

2 Invasion: An agressive entry into a place to conquer
sentences The army prepared for a sudden invasion at dawn.

3 cleavishly: In a silly or mischievous manner
sentences He grinned clownishly during the prank on friends

4 Rulership: The authority of being a ruler
sentences Her rulership brought peace to the entire Kingdom.

5 levity: lack of seriousness
sentences His jock added levity to tense meeting.

II Reference to Context:-

1 Screaming---------- me.

a Who is the speaker of these lines?
Ans Think-tank

b The speaker feels _____ and _____
(i) exposed, terrified (iii) intimated, stressed
(ii) terrified, excited (iv) nervous, terrified
Ans (i) exposed, terrified

c Why does the speaker scream? What does he fear?
Ans The speaker screams because he misinterprets a nursery rhyme as a threat from Earth. He fears that humans possess powerful weapons and advanced knowledge, believing they can destroy Mars. His panic stems from ignorance and overconfidence, leading to a hasty retreat.

III Answer the following Short Answers:-

Q1 Who is Think tank? Why does he send a space probe to earth?
Ans Think-Tank is the pompous and self-proclaimed ruler of Mars in 'The Book That Saved the Earth'. He sends a space probe to Earth to be primitive, he aims to conquer it easily. However, his ignorance and misinterpretation of a nursery rhyme book lead to panic and retreat.

Q2 How did the book change Think tank's opinion about the earthlings?
Ans The book, a nursery rhyme collection, made Think-Tank believe Earthlings were highly intelligent and dangerous. He misinterpreted the rhymes as coded threats and advanced knowledge. Fearing Earth's power, he panicked and called off the invasion, convinced that humans could destroy Mars.

Q 3 What does Think tank infere on listening to 'Hey diddle diddle'?

Ans On hearing "Hey Diddle Diddle", Think-Tank panics, believing Earthlings have trained animals for space warfare. He interprets the cow jumping over the moon as proof of advanced Earth technology and fears that humans can launch attacks on Mars. His misunderstanding leads him to see Earth as a dangerous and superior civilization.

IV Answer the following Long Answers:-

Q1 The play 'The Book that saved the Earth' conveys the message that misunderstanding of cultural differences between various races can cause confusion and conflict. Based on your reading, write down how such confusion can be checked so that the peace and harmony should prevail?

Ans Promote cultural education from an early age so people learn about customs, symbols, and histories of other communities workshops, and exchange programs build familiarity and reduce fear born of ignorance. Accurate translations and contextual explanations must accompany cultural texts and media.

Encourage open, respectful dialogue where questions are welcomed and differences explained calmly. Platforms for community conversations, interfaith councils, and school debates help clarify meanings and reveal shared values. Train educators, journalists, and leaders in active listening and cultural sensitivity to prevent caricatures and misreadings.

Establish verification mechanism for contested claims and rapid cultural-liaison teams to investigate and correct misunderstandings publicaly. Support responsible media practices and fact-checking to stop rumours, rebuild trust, and preserve peace.